



DSAT FOUNDATION PROGRAM

Craft and Structure

Words in Context • Text Structure and Purpose • Cross-Text Connections • theory with examples •
56 worked questions with Tip, Trap and Process of Elimination



How to use this deck

Every skill includes

- An opening slide with the big idea
- Theory: methods, traps and examples
- Spot-the-error practice pairs
- Worked examples with full solutions

How to study

- Read each method AND its example
- Try the question BEFORE the solution slide
- Compare your thinking with the Process
- Review the Tip and the Trap

Every solution shows

- Process: the step-by-step thinking
- Tip: a shortcut to remember
- Trap: the mistake to avoid
- Process of Elimination: every choice explained

ΠΩΣ ΝΑ ΧΡΗΣΙΜΟΠΟΙΗΣΕΤΕ ΑΥΤΗ ΤΗΝ ΠΑΡΟΥΣΙΑΣΗ

Αυτή η παρουσίαση καλύπτει τις τρεις δεξιότητες της ενότητας *Craft and Structure*. Κάθε δεξιότητα εξηγεί τη μέθοδο και τις παγίδες. Μελετήστε τα λυμένα παραδείγματα βήμα-βήμα πριν δείτε την απάντηση.

28%

THE DOMAIN

Craft and Structure at a glance



About 28% of the Reading & Writing score — roughly 13 to 15 questions across both modules

Words in Context

10–11

questions per test

100% rated Hard

Context-reading, not vocabulary.
Predict your own word first.

Text Structure and Purpose

up to 4

questions per test

96% rated Hard

Authorial intention, not content. Ask
what the text is DOING.

Cross-Text Connections

1

question per test

71% rated Hard

The relationship between two texts.
Summarize each, then name it.

3

Your 3 skills at a glance

1

Words in Context

Predict your own word first. Then match.

14 theory slides
32 worked examples

2

Text Structure and Purpose

Ask what the text is DOING, not what it says.

13 theory slides
16 worked examples

3

Cross-Text Connections

Name the relationship between two texts.

7 theory slides
8 worked examples

1

Words in Context

Predict your own word first. Then match.

Λέξεις στα Συμφραζόμενα

THEORY
14 slides

WORKED EXAMPLES
32 questions

The big idea



WHAT IT IS

Words in Context questions are not vocabulary tests. The sentence gives you the meaning. Your job is to build it from the clues, predict a word of your own, and only THEN match a choice.

EXAMPLE

*Though the plan was bold, the result was _____.
Predict “small” → choose “modest”.*

KEY TERM • ΕΛΛΗΝΙΚΑ

Λέξεις στα Συμφραζόμενα

Η κατανόηση του νοήματος μιας λέξης από την ίδια την πρόταση, όχι από το λεξικό.

WHY IT MATTERS

- 93% of these questions ask you to complete a blank
- 100% of the real questions in our bank are rated Hard
- The method matters more here than almost anywhere else

1

The 5-step strategy

1

Ignore the choices

Read the sentence cold. Predict a simple word of your own: use, change, show, reduce, hide, limit.

2

Use the sentence

Look for cause and effect, contrast, definitions (commas, dashes) and tone.

3

Test your word

Put your prediction in the blank and read it back. Natural and logical? That is your anchor.

4

Match closely

Choose the option nearest your prediction, not the most sophisticated one.

5

Avoid dictionary traps

Choices include the common meaning, a rare meaning and a smart-sounding misfit.

Four wrong-answer patterns

TRAP

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

EXAMPLE

Common-meaning trap

The most familiar meaning of the word is offered — usually wrong here.

“Novel” as a book, when the sentence needs “new”.

Sound-smart trap

A fancy word that does not fit the sentence’s logic.

“Ephemeral” in a sentence about steady growth.

Partial-fit trap

Fits one part of the sentence but clashes with its tone or direction.

“Cheerful” in a sentence about a gloomy forecast.

Extreme trap

Close in meaning but too strong or too weak.

“Devastated” instead of “disappointed”.

1

Meaning plus feeling

Denotation

- The dictionary meaning
- “Slender” and “emaciated” both mean thin

Connotation

- The feeling a word carries
- “Slender” is positive; “emaciated” is alarming
- Match the passage’s emotional register

Two habits

- Cover the blank and read the whole sentence
- Name the quality in your own words first
- Underlined word? Still use the context clues

Spot the clue, predict the word

CLUE TYPE	SIGNAL WORDS	WHAT THE BLANK MUST BE
Definition	<i>that is • in other words • or • also known as • a dash</i>	The same as the restated meaning.
Contrast	<i>however • but • although • yet • despite • whereas</i>	The opposite of the earlier idea.
Cause / effect	<i>because • so • therefore • as a result • consequently</i>	What the cause logically produces.
Example	<i>such as • for instance • including • like</i>	The quality all the examples share.

1

Definition clues: the sentence hands you the meaning

STEP	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE
1 • Find the restatement	<i>Look after a comma, a dash, “that is” or “in other words”.</i>	“...seen as ____ — that is, an attempt to avoid taking a clear position.”
2 • Make your own word	<i>Turn the definition into a simple word.</i>	“Avoid a position” → vague, dodging.
3 • Eliminate	<i>Cross out opposites and unrelated choices, however fancy.</i>	Not “transparent” — it means the opposite.
4 • Match precisely	<i>Pick the word that fits the stated meaning most exactly.</i>	equivocal



1

Contrast clues: the blank flips the idea

STEP

WHAT TO DO

EXAMPLE

1 • Find the signal

however, but, although, yet, despite, whereas, instead

“Although the early proposals were bold...”

2 • Name the earlier quality

What is being contrasted?

bold and sweeping

3 • Predict the opposite

The blank means roughly the reverse.

small, limited

4 • Eliminate the repeats

Choices that echo the earlier quality go first.

Not “ambitious” or “innovative”.

1

Cause and effect clues: follow the logic

STEP	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE
1 • Find the signal	<i>because, so, therefore, as a result, consequently</i>	“Because the cables had corroded badly...”
2 • Name the cause	<i>Is it positive, negative or specific?</i>	A negative event: corrosion.
3 • Predict the effect	<i>What would this cause logically produce?</i>	dangerous
4 • Eliminate the opposites	<i>Remove choices describing the reverse outcome.</i>	Not “sturdy”.



1

Example clues: name what the examples share

STEP**WHAT TO DO****EXAMPLE****1 • Find the examples***such as, for instance, including, like*

“...such as deep-fried scorpion and fermented shark.”

2 • Find what they share*What quality or category links them?*

unusual, surprising

3 • Name it in one word*Predict a word for the shared quality.*

unconventional

4 • Eliminate the unsupported*If the examples do not show it, it is out.*

Not “affordable” — no price is mentioned.

1

Spot the trap — and fix it

WRONG

✗ Though the first draft was dense, the revision was refreshingly complex.

✗ Because the river had dried up, the village's water supply was plentiful.

✗ The gallery displays modern pieces, such as a 2,000-year-old vase.

✗ Her speech was terse, that is, long and full of detail.

RIGHT

✓ Though the first draft was dense, the revision was refreshingly clear.

✓ Because the river had dried up, the village's water supply was scarce.

✓ The gallery displays ancient pieces, such as a 2,000-year-old vase.

✓ Her speech was terse, that is, brief and to the point.

WHY

"Though" flips the idea; "complex" repeats "dense".

The cause points to a shortage.

The example shows great age.

The definition after "that is" must match.

1

Scientific terms you must recognize

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS	SAT TRAP
Sample size	<i>How many subjects were studied. Small = shaky; large = more reliable.</i>	Confusing “large sample” with “strong proof”.
Longitudinal study	<i>Tracks the same subjects over a long time to find trends.</i>	Mixing it up with cross-sectional (one snapshot).
Model validation	<i>Checking whether a model’s predictions match real data.</i>	Assuming a validated model is always correct.
Proxy measure	<i>A stand-in measurement for something hard to observe.</i>	Treating the proxy as the real variable.

1

Scientific terms you must recognize

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS	SAT TRAP
Experimental group	<i>The group that receives the treatment or new condition.</i>	Confusing it with the control group.
Control group	<i>The no-treatment comparison that isolates the variable.</i>	Thinking “control” means “controlled conditions”.
Confounding variable	<i>An unseen factor that muddles the results.</i>	Ignoring it when judging a conclusion.
Independent variable	<i>The factor scientists deliberately change.</i>	Swapping it with the dependent variable.



1

Scientific terms you must recognize

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS	SAT TRAP
Dependent variable	<i>The outcome being measured.</i>	Swapping it with the independent variable.
Correlation vs. causation	<i>Correlation: variables change together. Causation: one produces the other.</i>	Assuming correlation proves cause.
Competing hypotheses	<i>Different explanations compared against evidence.</i>	Treating one hypothesis as proven fact.
Evolutionary trade-off	<i>A trait that helps in one situation but costs in another.</i>	Seeing evolution as purely beneficial.

Words in Context: top rules



Before the choices

- Predict your own word
- Cover the blank, read the sentence

Signal words

- However, but, yet, although → opposite
- Because, so, therefore → cause and effect
- Colons and dashes introduce definitions

Watch out

- Tone removes at least one wrong choice
- The most common meaning is almost always wrong
- Sophisticated does not mean correct

Worked Example 1.1



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The committee's decision to delay the vote was widely seen as _____ — that is, an attempt to avoid taking a clear position before the election.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A courageous

B equivocal

C transparent

D unanimous

1

Worked Example 1.1: Solution

Answer: B — equivocal

PROCESS

1. Find the definition after the dash: “an attempt to avoid taking a clear position”.
2. Turn it into your own word: “vague” or “dodging”.
3. Match the choice closest to that meaning.
4. “Equivocal” means deliberately unclear.

TIP

- The phrase after “that is” IS the answer — read it first.
- Predict a simple word before you look at A–D.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Courageous” is the opposite of avoiding a position.
- B** ✓ **“Equivocal” means deliberately unclear — it matches the definition.**
- C** ✗ “Transparent” means open and clear, the opposite.
- D** ✗ “Unanimous” is about agreement, not avoidance.

TRAP

- “Transparent” sounds formal and positive but means the opposite.
- Choosing a word you know instead of the one the sentence defines.



1

Worked Example 1.2

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Many critics considered the film's ending _____, or unresolved, leaving audiences uncertain how to interpret the protagonist's fate.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A triumphant

B ambiguous

C predictable

D tedious

1

Worked Example 1.2: Solution

Answer: B — ambiguous

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “or unresolved” restates the blank.
2. Predict: “unclear” or “open to more than one reading”.
3. Check the second clue: audiences are “uncertain”.
4. “Ambiguous” fits both clues.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Triumphant” implies a clear, happy resolution.
- B** ✓ **“Ambiguous” means unresolved and open to interpretation.**
- C** ✗ “Predictable” would leave no uncertainty.
- D** ✗ “Tedious” means boring; nothing says the ending is unresolved.

TIP

- After a blank, “or” can introduce the definition.
- Use the effect on the audience (“uncertain”) as a second clue.

TRAP

- “Predictable” is a familiar film word but contradicts “uncertain”.
- Picking a word about quality (“tedious”) instead of meaning.



1

Worked Example 1.3

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The professor's lecture style could be described as _____ — that is, delivered in a plain, straightforward manner without embellishment.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A ornate

B unadorned

C spirited

D inaudible

1

Worked Example 1.3: Solution

Answer: B — unadorned

PROCESS

1. Find the definition: “plain, straightforward... without embellishment”.
2. Predict: “simple” or “plain”.
3. Eliminate choices that mean the opposite or something unrelated.
4. “Unadorned” means without decoration.

TIP

- “Without embellishment” is a clue about the word itself: un- often means “without”.
- Match EVERY part of the definition, not just one word.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Ornate” means elaborate, the opposite of plain.
- B** ✓ **“Unadorned” means plain and without decoration.**
- C** ✗ “Spirited” means lively; the definition says plain.
- D** ✗ “Inaudible” is about volume, not style.

TRAP

- “Spirited” is a common positive word for lectures, but nothing says lively.
- Missing that “ornate” is the exact opposite.

Worked Example 1.4



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The new policy was criticized as _____, meaning it applied the same standard regardless of individual circumstances.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A flexible

B rigid

C generous

D vague

1

Worked Example 1.4: Solution

Answer: B — rigid

PROCESS

1. Find the definition: “applied the same standard regardless of circumstances”.
2. Predict: “unbending”.
3. Note the tone: the policy was “criticized”, so the word is negative.
4. “Rigid” fits.

TIP

- “Same... regardless” = it never bends.
- “Criticized as” signals a negative word.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Flexible” is the opposite of one fixed standard.
- B** ✓ **“Rigid” means unbending.**
- C** ✗ “Generous” is not about standards.
- D** ✗ “Vague” means unclear, not unchanging.

TRAP

- “Vague” is a criticism word, but it means unclear, not unvarying.
- Positive words cannot follow “criticized as”.

Worked Example 1.5



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Investors described the startup's growth as _____ — in other words, expanding at an unsustainable, breakneck pace.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A modest

B meteoric

C gradual

D stagnant

1

Worked Example 1.5: Solution

Answer: B — meteoric

PROCESS

1. Find the restatement: “unsustainable, breakneck pace”.
2. Predict: “extremely fast”.
3. Notice three choices describe slow or absent growth.
4. “Meteoric” means rising very fast.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Modest” means small, the opposite of breakneck.
- B** ✓ **“Meteoric” means rising extremely fast.**
- C** ✗ “Gradual” means slow.
- D** ✗ “Stagnant” means not growing at all.

TIP

- Three choices mean the same thing? They are probably all wrong.
- “Breakneck” and “unsustainable” both point to speed.

TRAP

- “Meteoric” may look like a space word; here it is figurative: shooting upward.
- Choosing a familiar word that is too weak.

Worked Example 1.6



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The negotiator's approach was _____, that is, willing to make small concessions in order to reach a broader agreement.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A intransigent

B conciliatory

C hostile

D indifferent

1

Worked Example 1.6: Solution

Answer: B — conciliatory

PROCESS

1. Find the definition: “willing to make small concessions”.
2. Predict: “willing to compromise”.
3. Eliminate opposites first.
4. “Conciliatory” means seeking agreement.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Intransigent” means unwilling to compromise.
- B** ✓ **“Conciliatory” means seeking agreement through concessions.**
- C** ✗ “Hostile” means unfriendly, the opposite of conceding.
- D** ✗ “Indifferent” means not caring; it says nothing about concessions.

TIP

- “Concessions” = giving a little ground.
- Predict “willing to compromise” before reading the choices.

TRAP

- “Intransigent” looks smart and sounds like negotiation, but it means the opposite.
- Choosing a negative word for a positive definition.

Worked Example 1.7



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The scientist's hypothesis was considered _____
— in other words, capable of being tested and
potentially proven false through experiment.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A speculative

B falsifiable

C irrefutable

D obsolete

1

Worked Example 1.7: Solution

Answer: B — falsifiable

PROCESS

1. Find the restatement: “capable of being tested and potentially proven false”.
2. Predict: “testable”.
3. Match BOTH parts: testable AND could be shown wrong.
4. “Falsifiable” fits.

TIP

- Check every part of the definition.
- A science term in the answer choices usually echoes the definition.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Speculative” means guesswork; it does not mention testing.
- B** ✓ “Falsifiable” means it can be tested and possibly shown false.
- C** ✗ “Irrefutable” means it cannot be disproved, the opposite.
- D** ✗ “Obsolete” means outdated.

TRAP

- “Irrefutable” sounds scientific and strong but means it CANNOT be disproved.
- “Speculative” shares the topic but not the meaning.



1

Worked Example 1.8

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The committee praised the report for being _____, meaning it addressed every relevant aspect of the issue without leaving gaps.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A comprehensive

B concise

C preliminary

D biased

1

Worked Example 1.8: Solution

Answer: A — comprehensive

PROCESS

1. Find the definition: “every relevant aspect... without gaps”.
2. Predict: “complete”.
3. Note the tone: the committee “praised” it.
4. “Comprehensive” fits.

TIP

- “Every... without gaps” = complete.
- “Praised” rules out negative words such as “biased”.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A ✓** “Comprehensive” means covering everything.
- B ✗** “Concise” means brief, the opposite of covering every aspect.
- C ✗** “Preliminary” means early-stage.
- D ✗** “Biased” is negative and the committee praised the report.

TRAP

- “Concise” is a common praise word for reports but means short, not complete.
- Ignoring the word “praised”.



1

Worked Example 1.9

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Although the committee's early proposals were bold and sweeping, the final policy that passed was comparatively _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A ambitious

B modest

C controversial

D innovative

1

Worked Example 1.9: Solution

Answer: B — modest

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Although”.
2. Name the earlier quality: “bold and sweeping”.
3. Predict the opposite: “small” or “limited”.
4. “Modest” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Ambitious” repeats “bold and sweeping”.
- B** ✓ **“Modest” means restrained, the opposite of sweeping.**
- C** ✗ “Controversial” is unrelated to scope.
- D** ✗ “Innovative” echoes “bold”.

TIP

- Signal word + quality = predict the opposite.
- “Although” always flips the direction.

TRAP

- Two choices repeat “bold” in other words — the most common contrast trap.
- “Controversial” feels natural after “bold” but ignores the contrast.



1

Worked Example 1.10

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The critic's early reviews were scathing, but her tone in the retrospective essay was notably _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A harsh

B generous

C confusing

D brief

1

Worked Example 1.10: Solution

Answer: B — generous

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “but”.
2. Name the earlier quality: “scathing” (very harsh).
3. Predict the opposite: “kind”.
4. “Generous” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Harsh” repeats “scathing”.
- B** ✓ **“Generous” means kind and favorable.**
- C** ✗ “Confusing” has nothing to do with a tone shift.
- D** ✗ “Brief” is about length.

TIP

- Turn the earlier word into its opposite: harsh → kind.
- Underline the signal before reading the choices.

TRAP

- “Harsh” repeats the earlier idea instead of reversing it.
- Choosing an unrelated word that merely names a tone.



1

Worked Example 1.11

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Despite the company's reputation for secrecy, its new CEO has been remarkably _____ about the firm's financial struggles.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A evasive

B forthcoming

C indifferent

D cautious



1

Worked Example 1.11: Solution

Answer: B — forthcoming

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Despite”.
2. Name the earlier quality: “secrecy”.
3. Predict the opposite: “open”.
4. “Forthcoming” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Evasive” matches secrecy, contradicting “despite”.
- B** ✓ **“Forthcoming” means open and willing to share.**
- C** ✗ “Indifferent” says nothing about openness.
- D** ✗ “Cautious” also matches secrecy.

TIP

- “Despite” always flips the direction.
- Predict “open” before you read A–D.

TRAP

- Two choices continue the “secrecy” idea.
- “Indifferent” is negative-sounding and tempting after “struggles”.



1

Worked Example 1.12

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The novel's plot is famously convoluted, yet its central theme remains surprisingly _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A complex

B clear

C obscure

D ironic

1

Worked Example 1.12: Solution

Answer: B — clear

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “yet”.
2. Name the earlier quality: “convoluted” (complicated).
3. Predict the opposite: “simple”.
4. “Clear” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Complex” repeats “convoluted”.
- B** ✓ **“Clear” is the opposite of convoluted.**
- C** ✗ “Obscure” also means hard to understand.
- D** ✗ “Ironic” is unrelated to clarity.

TIP

- “Yet” and “surprisingly” both signal a reversal.
- Two clue words agreeing = strong evidence.

TRAP

- “Complex” and “obscure” both extend the “convoluted” idea.
- “Ironic” sounds literary but says nothing about clarity.



1

Worked Example 1.13

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The team's defense had been porous all season, but in the championship game it proved unexpectedly _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A leaky

B solid

C predictable

D aggressive

1

Worked Example 1.13: Solution

Answer: B — solid

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “but” (and “unexpectedly”).
2. Name the earlier quality: “porous” (full of holes).
3. Predict the opposite: “strong”.
4. “Solid” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Leaky” repeats “porous”.
- B** ✓ **“Solid” means strong and without holes.**
- C** ✗ “Predictable” does not address strength.
- D** ✗ “Aggressive” describes style, not strength.

TIP

- Define the earlier word in plain English, then flip it.
- “Unexpectedly” confirms a reversal.

TRAP

- “Leaky” is just “porous” in disguise.
- “Aggressive” sounds like a defensive word but does not reverse weakness.



1

Worked Example 1.14

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Though the museum's older wing feels cramped and outdated, the new addition is spacious and _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A modern

B dim

C crowded

D traditional



1

Worked Example 1.14: Solution

Answer: A — modern

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Though”.
2. Name the earlier qualities: “cramped and outdated”.
3. Predict the opposites: “roomy” and “up to date”.
4. “Modern” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A ✓** “Modern” is the opposite of outdated.
- B ✗** “Dim” continues the negative description.
- C ✗** “Crowded” contradicts “spacious”.
- D ✗** “Traditional” means old-fashioned, like “outdated”.

TIP

- The blank pairs with “spacious”: both must be positive.
- Flip BOTH earlier qualities, not just one.

TRAP

- “Traditional” sounds museum-like but means old-fashioned, same as “outdated”.
- “Crowded” is the opposite of “spacious”.



1

Worked Example 1.15

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The professor's writing is often dense and inaccessible, whereas her lectures are refreshingly _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A technical

B lucid

C monotonous

D lengthy

1

Worked Example 1.15: Solution

Answer: B — lucid

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “whereas”.
2. Name the earlier quality: “dense and inaccessible”.
3. Predict the opposite: “easy to follow”.
4. “Lucid” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Technical” matches dense writing.
- B** ✓ **“Lucid” means clear and easy to understand.**
- C** ✗ “Monotonous” is negative, but not the opposite of dense.
- D** ✗ “Lengthy” is about duration.

TIP

- “Whereas” sets two things side by side as opposites.
- “Refreshingly” also points to a positive word.

TRAP

- “Technical” matches “dense” — the wrong direction.
- Picking a word you know over one that means “clear”.



1

Worked Example 1.16

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Although early drafts of the bill faced fierce opposition, the version ultimately signed into law was met with surprising _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A resistance

B approval

C confusion

D delay



1

Worked Example 1.16: Solution

Answer: B — approval

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Although” (and “surprising”).
2. Name the earlier quality: “fierce opposition”.
3. Predict the opposite: “support”.
4. “Approval” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Resistance” repeats “opposition”.
- B** ✓ **“Approval” is the opposite of opposition.**
- C** ✗ “Confusion” is unrelated to reception.
- D** ✗ “Delay” is unrelated to reception.

TIP

- Repeat-the-idea choices are usually wrong in contrast questions.
- “Surprising” confirms the flip.

TRAP

- “Resistance” repeats “opposition”.
- Choosing a word about the bill’s history instead of its reception.



1

Worked Example 1.17

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Because the bridge's support cables had corroded badly, engineers deemed the structure _____ and closed it to traffic.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A sturdy

B unsafe

C picturesque

D temporary

1

Worked Example 1.17: Solution

Answer: B — unsafe

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Because”.
2. Name the cause: cables corroded badly.
3. Predict the effect: engineers closed it — so it is “dangerous”.
4. “Unsafe” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Sturdy” is the opposite of what corrosion causes.
- B** ✓ **“Unsafe” explains why the bridge was closed.**
- C** ✗ “Picturesque” is about looks.
- D** ✗ “Temporary” is unrelated to safety.

TIP

- A bad cause leads to a bad effect.
- Use the second clue: “closed it to traffic”.

TRAP

- “Temporary” fits “closed” but ignores the corrosion cause.
- Positive words contradict the cause.

Worked Example 1.18



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The drought had lasted nearly a year, so the reservoir's water level was _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A rising

B depleted

C stable

D contaminated

1

Worked Example 1.18: Solution

Answer: B — depleted

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “so”.
2. Name the cause: a year-long drought.
3. Predict the effect on a water level: “very low”.
4. “Depleted” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Rising” is the opposite of a drought’s effect.
- B** ✓ **“Depleted” means used up or low.**
- C** ✗ “Stable” contradicts a year-long drought.
- D** ✗ “Contaminated” is about purity, not quantity.

TIP

- Ask: what does a drought usually do?
- A level can only rise, fall or stay — pick the one the cause supports.

TRAP

- “Contaminated” sounds like a water problem but a drought affects quantity.
- Reading “water” and ignoring “level”.



1

Worked Example 1.19

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

As a result of the factory's new automated equipment, production errors _____ significantly.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A increased

B declined

C persisted

D diversified

1

Worked Example 1.19: Solution

Answer: B — declined

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “As a result of”.
2. Name the cause: new automated equipment.
3. Predict the effect on errors: “dropped”.
4. “Declined” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Increased” contradicts the expected benefit.
- B** ✓ **“Declined” means fell.**
- C** ✗ “Persisted” means stayed the same.
- D** ✗ “Diversified” is about variety, not amount.

TIP

- Ask what automation usually does to errors.
- “Significantly” needs a change verb, not “persisted”.

TRAP

- “Persisted” means no change, but “significantly” demands a change.
- Choosing the opposite of the expected benefit.



1

Worked Example 1.20

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Because a late frost had damaged most of the blossoms, local farmers expected a _____ harvest.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A abundant

B meager

C diverse

D early

1

Worked Example 1.20: Solution

Answer: B — meager

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Because”.
2. Name the cause: a frost damaged most blossoms.
3. Predict the effect on the harvest: “small”.
4. “Meager” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Abundant” is the opposite of the expected result.
- B** ✓ **“Meager” means small in amount.**
- C** ✗ “Diverse” is about variety.
- D** ✗ “Early” is not supported by the cause.

TIP

- Damaged blossoms mean less fruit.
- Predict the direction (more or less) before the word.

TRAP

- “Early” sounds like a frost-and-season word, but nothing in the sentence is about timing.
- “Abundant” is the opposite of the logical effect.



1

Worked Example 1.21

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The airline's on-time performance had slipped for three straight quarters; consequently, customer satisfaction scores _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A improved

B plummeted

C stabilized

D diversified

1

Worked Example 1.21: Solution

Answer: B — plummeted

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “consequently”.
2. Name the cause: three quarters of worse punctuality.
3. Predict the effect: scores fell.
4. “Plummeted” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Improved” contradicts a negative trend.
- B** ✓ **“Plummeted” means fell sharply.**
- C** ✗ “Stabilized” means stopped changing.
- D** ✗ “Diversified” is unrelated.

TIP

- A negative cause gives a negative effect.
- “Three straight quarters” suggests a strong result.

TRAP

- “Stabilized” does not describe a decline.
- Choosing a positive word after a negative trend.



1

Worked Example 1.22

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Because the vaccine trial included over ten thousand participants across multiple countries, researchers considered its results particularly _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A inconclusive

B robust

C premature

D biased

1

Worked Example 1.22: Solution

Answer: B — robust

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “Because”.
2. Name the cause: a very large, international sample.
3. Predict the effect on confidence: “strong”.
4. “Robust” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Inconclusive” means unclear.
- B** ✓ **“Robust” means strong and reliable.**
- C** ✗ “Premature” means too early.
- D** ✗ “Biased” contradicts a diverse sample.

TIP

- Large and diverse sample = strong result (see the science vocabulary).
- When three choices are negative, the positive one stands out.

TRAP

- Three choices share the same wrong direction.
- “Premature” sounds scientific but means too early.



1

Worked Example 1.23

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The city's water main had not been inspected in over forty years; therefore, engineers were not at all _____ when it finally failed.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A surprised

B relieved

C impressed

D confused

1

Worked Example 1.23: Solution

Answer: A — surprised

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “therefore”.
2. Name the cause: no inspection for forty years.
3. Predict the effect: the failure was expected — so engineers were not shocked.
4. Read the negation back: “not at all surprised”.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A ✓** “Not at all surprised” matches an expected failure.
- B ✗** “Relieved” does not fit a structural failure.
- C ✗** “Impressed” does not fit an overdue failure.
- D ✗** “Confused” contradicts an outcome the sentence says was expected.

TIP

- Predict BEFORE you apply the negative: “not at all ____” flips the meaning.
- Read the whole phrase back with your choice in it.

TRAP

- Forgetting “not at all” and choosing a word for the opposite reaction.
- “Confused” sounds plausible after a failure.

1

Worked Example 1.24

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The startup burned through its entire funding round in under six months; unsurprisingly, it was forced to _____ operations shortly after.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A expand

B suspend

C relocate

D diversify

1

Worked Example 1.24: Solution

Answer: B — suspend

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “unsurprisingly”.
2. Name the cause: all the money was spent.
3. Predict the effect: it had to “stop” operations.
4. “Suspend” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Expand” contradicts running out of money.
- B** ✓ **“Suspend” means temporarily stop.**
- C** ✗ “Relocate” does not follow from lack of funds.
- D** ✗ “Diversify” does not follow from lack of funds.

TIP

- “Unsurprisingly” means the result matches the cause.
- Ask: what happens to a business with no money?

TRAP

- “Relocate” and “diversify” are business words that sound plausible.
- Choosing a growth word after running out of money.

Worked Example 1.25



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The chef's menu features several _____ dishes, such as deep-fried scorpion and fermented shark.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A traditional

B unconventional

C affordable

D seasonal

1

Worked Example 1.25: Solution

Answer: B — unconventional

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “such as”.
2. Read the examples: scorpion and fermented shark.
3. Name what they share: unusual.
4. “Unconventional” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Traditional” does not describe scorpion and shark.
- B** ✓ **“Unconventional” means unusual.**
- C** ✗ Cost is not revealed by the examples.
- D** ✗ Season is not revealed by the examples.

TIP

- Ask: what do the examples have in common?
- The blank names the shared quality.

TRAP

- “Traditional” sounds menu-like but the examples are not typical.
- Choosing a word about price or season that the examples never mention.



1

Worked Example 1.26

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The museum's collection includes several _____ artifacts, including a 3,000-year-old scroll and a set of Bronze Age tools.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A modern

B ancient

C fragile

D digital

1

Worked Example 1.26: Solution

Answer: B — ancient

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “including”.
2. Read the examples: a 3,000-year-old scroll; Bronze Age tools.
3. Name what they share: great age.
4. “Ancient” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Modern” contradicts very old items.
- B** ✓ **“Ancient” means very old.**
- C** ✗ Fragility is not stated.
- D** ✗ Nothing suggests digital items.

TIP

- Numbers and dates in examples are strong clues.
- Pick the word the examples PROVE, not one they might allow.

TRAP

- “Fragile” is plausible for old objects, but the examples show age, not fragility.
- Missing that “modern” contradicts the dates.



1

Worked Example 1.27

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The committee approved several _____ measures, such as banning plastic straws and requiring solar panels on new buildings.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A economic

B environmental

C educational

D temporary

1

Worked Example 1.27: Solution

Answer: B — environmental

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “such as”.
2. Read the examples: banning plastic straws; solar panels.
3. Name what they share: protecting nature.
4. “Environmental” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Economic” is not what the examples show.
- B** ✓ **“Environmental” covers both plastic and solar power.**
- C** ✗ “Educational” is not shown.
- D** ✗ Nothing says the measures are temporary.

TIP

- Find the category that covers ALL the examples.
- One example is not enough; both must fit.

TRAP

- “Economic” is a common policy word but the examples are not about money.
- Choosing a word that fits only one example.



1

Worked Example 1.28

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The professor is known for assigning _____ texts, including dense philosophical treatises and untranslated Latin poetry.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A entertaining

B challenging

C short

D contemporary

1

Worked Example 1.28: Solution

Answer: B — challenging

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “including”.
2. Read the examples: dense treatises; untranslated Latin.
3. Name what they share: hard to read.
4. “Challenging” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Entertaining” contradicts dense, difficult material.
- B** ✓ **“Challenging” means difficult.**
- C** ✗ “Short” contradicts dense treatises.
- D** ✗ “Contemporary” contradicts ancient Latin.

TIP

- Descriptive words in the examples (“dense”, “untranslated”) name the quality.
- Choose the plain word: hard.

TRAP

- “Short” and “contemporary” both contradict the examples.
- Picking a positive word for hard texts.



1

Worked Example 1.29

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The startup offers several _____ perks to employees, such as unlimited vacation days and fully paid sabbaticals.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A standard

B generous

C confusing

D mandatory

1

Worked Example 1.29: Solution

Answer: B — generous

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “such as”.
2. Read the examples: unlimited vacation; paid sabbaticals.
3. Name what they share: more than usual.
4. “Generous” fits.

TIP

- “Unlimited” and “fully paid” are strength words — match them.
- Avoid words the examples do not support.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Standard” means ordinary.
- B** ✓ **“Generous” means more than expected.**
- C** ✗ Nothing shows the perks are confusing.
- D** ✗ Nothing shows the perks are required.

TRAP

- “Standard” is the opposite of unusually large perks.
- “Mandatory” is plausible for vacations but nothing says required.



1

Worked Example 1.30

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The region is home to several _____ species, including a fish that survives in nearly boiling water and a beetle that thrives in solid ice.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A common

B extremophile

C endangered

D migratory

1

Worked Example 1.30: Solution

Answer: B — extremophile

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “including”.
2. Read the examples: boiling water; solid ice.
3. Name what they share: surviving extreme conditions.
4. “Extremophile” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Common” does not describe extreme species.
- B** ✓ **“Extremophile” means thriving in extreme conditions.**
- C** ✗ Population status is not shown.
- D** ✗ Migration is not shown.

TIP

- Break an unfamiliar word apart: extreme + -phile (loving).
- The examples define it even if you have never seen it.

TRAP

- Avoiding the unfamiliar word and choosing a familiar one that does not fit.
- “Endangered” is common in nature sentences but is not shown.

Worked Example 1.31



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The novelist employs several _____ techniques, such as switching narrators mid-chapter and presenting events out of chronological order.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A conventional

B experimental

C repetitive

D simplistic

1

Worked Example 1.31: Solution

Answer: B — experimental

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “such as”.
2. Read the examples: switching narrators; scrambled time order.
3. Name what they share: breaking the usual rules.
4. “Experimental” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ “Conventional” means standard.
- B** ✓ **“Experimental” means trying new methods.**
- C** ✗ Repetition is not shown.
- D** ✗ Neither technique is simple.

TIP

- Ask: are the examples normal or unusual?
- Two choices (conventional, simplistic) contradict them.

TRAP

- “Repetitive” is not shown by either example.
- Choosing the plain word “conventional” — the examples are the opposite.



1

Worked Example 1.32

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The city council introduced several _____ policies, including a program that pays residents to remove their lawns and a ban on watering gardens during summer afternoons.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A controversial

B water-conscious

C expensive

D temporary

1

Worked Example 1.32: Solution

Answer: B — water-conscious

PROCESS

1. Find the signal: “including”.
2. Read the examples: paying to remove lawns; limiting watering.
3. Name what they share: saving water.
4. “Water-conscious” fits.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ Public reaction is not shown.
- B** ✓ **Both examples are about saving water.**
- C** ✗ Cost is not addressed.
- D** ✗ Duration is not addressed.

TIP

- Find the ONE idea that links both examples.
- Be precise: choose the narrowest word that covers both.

TRAP

- “Controversial” describes reactions, not what the examples show.
- “Expensive” fits the lawn program but not the watering ban.

2

Text Structure and Purpose

Ask what the text is DOING, not what it says.

Δομή και Σκοπός Κειμένου

THEORY
13 slides

WORKED EXAMPLES
16 questions

The big idea



WHAT IT IS

Text Structure and Purpose questions reward readers who think like authors. The exam is not asking what the passage says; it asks why it was built that way. MAIN PURPOSE questions ask about the whole text. FUNCTION questions ask about one sentence.

EXAMPLE

“Cognitive research, however, shows a time cost.” Its job: challenge the earlier claim.

KEY TERM • ΕΛΛΗΝΙΚΑ

Δομή και Σκοπός Κειμένου

Η κατανόηση του ΓΙΑΤΙ ο συγγραφέας έγραψε ένα κείμενο ή μια πρόταση με συγκεκριμένο τρόπο.

WHY IT MATTERS

- “Function” wording appears 56% of the time; “main purpose” 31%
- Rated Hard 96% of the time — tied for the hardest skill
- One consistent method works for both question types

The 8-point system



1 • Name the job

Introducing, giving evidence, explaining, countering, conceding, concluding.

2 • Find clue words

Because, however, moreover, for instance, thus.

3 • Ask why it is there

If it disappeared, what would the passage lose?

4 • Match the big picture

True but irrelevant is still wrong.

5 • Read the whole text

Do not zoom in on a single phrase.

6 • Use the function test

“The author includes this in order to...”

7 • Spot wrong patterns

Too extreme, wrong tone, new ideas, misread stance.

8 • Practise daily

Ask “What is the author doing?” in everything you read.

Disappearance test and verb test

Disappearance test

- Mentally delete the sentence
- Ask what the passage loses
- The answer names it: a transition, an example, a qualification, a counterpoint

Verb test

- Read the FIRST word of each choice
- Decide your verb before the full choice
- Cross out every wrong verb first

Watch out

- “However” does not always mean challenge
- A true statement can be the wrong purpose
- Cut ideas that are not in the text

The verbs the exam uses

VERB**WHAT THE SENTENCE DOES****TYPICAL CLUE****Introduce***Opens a topic or a claim*

“Many assume that...”

Establish*Sets a fact or background*

“Since 2010, ...”

Support / illustrate*Gives evidence or an example*

for instance • such as

Complicate / qualify*Adds a limit or a drawback*

however • but • not all



The verbs the exam uses

VERB**WHAT THE SENTENCE DOES****TYPICAL CLUE****Challenge / counter***Argues against an earlier idea*

however • critics argue

Concede*Gives a point to the other side*

admittedly • granted • to be sure

Conclude*Wraps up the point*

thus • therefore • in summary

Transition*Moves to a new idea*

next • turning to

Emphasize*Stresses importance*

indeed • above all

Patterns the exam loves



PATTERN

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

HOW IT SOUNDS

Claim → Evidence → Conclusion

Main idea first, examples in the middle, summary at the end

“Later start times help. Studies show... So schools should...”

Problem → Solution

A challenge is described, then an approach is offered

“Landfills overflow. Composting diverts waste.”

Observation → Explanation

A phenomenon is described, then its cause is proposed

“Corals turn white. Heat forces them to expel algae.”

Patterns the exam loves



PATTERN

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

HOW IT SOUNDS

Claim → Counter → Rebuttal

A claim, an objection acknowledged, then a defense

“Some say... Yet...”

Chronological

Events or discoveries in time order

“In 1928... Later...”

Comparison

Two things, approaches or ideas set side by side

“Unlike the first method, the second...”

Main purpose: the method



STEP	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE
1 • State the job	<i>One sentence of your own: explain, argue, describe, compare, raise a question.</i>	"It explains what coral bleaching is and what it causes."
2 • Cut the extremes	<i>Remove choices stronger than the passage.</i>	"Definitively warm-blooded" — the text says "middle ground".
3 • Cut the missing	<i>Remove facts or arguments the passage never makes.</i>	A comparison with other kinds of pollution.
4 • Cut the narrow	<i>Remove choices that cover only one detail.</i>	A choice about one sentence of the passage.
5 • Match	<i>Pick the choice that fits your statement.</i>	"To explain the process and consequences of coral bleaching."

Four traps in purpose questions

TRAP

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

WHY IT FAILS

Too extreme

“Argue”, “prove” or “criticize” for a neutral text

The passage never goes that far.

Too narrow

Describes one detail of the passage

The question asks for the whole job.

Not in the text

Introduces a topic never discussed

You cannot choose what is not there.

Wrong stance

Misreads the author’s attitude

Tone decides: neutral is not critical.

Function: the method

STEP

WHAT TO DO

EXAMPLE

1 • Reread around

Read the sentence plus the one before and the one after.

Praise → “however” → future plans

2 • Disappearance test

Delete it: what does the passage lose?

The limit on the program’s success

3 • Predict the verb

introduce, support, qualify, counter, concede, conclude

qualify

4 • Check verbs, then details

Cross out wrong first words, then confirm the rest.

“To introduce a limitation...”

What the signal word usually tells you

SIGNAL**USUALLY MEANS****EXAMPLE****however • yet • but***Challenge or qualify*

“...praised. Enrollment, however, remains voluntary.”

admittedly • granted*Concede*

“Admittedly, early pilots looked promising.”

for example • such as*Illustrate*

“...industries such as healthcare.”

therefore • thus*Conclude, or state a result*

“Composting therefore addresses both problems.”

moreover • furthermore*Add support in the same direction*

“Moreover, costs fell.”

maintain • argue • claim*Report someone’s view*

“Manufacturers maintain that...”

Spot the function error — and fix it

WRONG

✗ “However...” = the author refutes the whole passage.

✗ “Admittedly...” = the author concludes the passage.

✗ “For example...” = the author introduces a new topic.

✗ Main purpose = the most interesting detail.

RIGHT

✓ “However...” = the author qualifies the point just made.

✓ “Admittedly...” = the author concedes a point.

✓ “For example...” = the author illustrates the previous claim.

✓ Main purpose = the job of the whole passage.

WHY

One limit is not a total rejection.

“Admittedly” gives ground.

Examples support what came before.

Purpose is about the whole text.

Text structure in three lines



Ask

- What is this DOING?
- Not: what does it say?

Memorize

- introduce • support • challenge
- qualify • concede • conclude
- However → challenge; for example → illustrate

Watch out

- Disappearance test for underlined sentences
- Cut ideas that are not in the passage
- True but irrelevant = wrong

Worked Example 2.1



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Coral bleaching occurs when rising ocean temperatures cause coral to expel the algae living in their tissues, draining the coral of its color and a major food source. While a bleached coral is not immediately dead, prolonged heat stress makes recovery increasingly unlikely, and repeated bleaching events over the past decade have devastated reef systems worldwide.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To argue that ocean temperatures are rising faster than scientists predicted
- B** To explain the process and consequences of coral bleaching
- C** To describe a successful method for reversing coral bleaching
- D** To compare coral bleaching to other forms of ocean pollution

2

Worked Example 2.1: Solution

Answer: B — To explain the process and consequences of coral bleaching

PROCESS

1. State the job in one sentence: it explains what bleaching is and what it causes.
2. Test each choice against that sentence.
3. Cross out choices with ideas the passage never mentions.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The passage never says temperatures rose faster than predicted.
- B** ✓ **It explains how bleaching happens and what follows.**
- C** ✗ Recovery is described as unlikely — the opposite of a successful method.
- D** ✗ No other pollution is mentioned.

TIP

- Name the passage's JOB, not its content: explain, argue, describe, compare.
- Two choices that add new ideas can go at once.

TRAP

- "Faster than predicted" sounds scientific, but predictions are never mentioned.
- A choice about reversing bleaching, when the passage says recovery is unlikely.

Worked Example 2.2



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

For decades, paleontologists assumed that all dinosaurs were cold-blooded, like modern reptiles. Recent analysis of bone growth patterns, however, suggests many species grew at rates more typical of warm-blooded animals. This has led researchers to propose that dinosaurs may have occupied a metabolic middle ground unlike any animal alive today.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To criticize earlier paleontologists for a flawed methodology
- B** To present new evidence that complicates a long-held assumption about dinosaur biology
- C** To argue that dinosaurs were definitively warm-blooded
- D** To describe how modern reptiles differ from birds

2

Worked Example 2.2: Solution

Answer: B — To present new evidence that complicates a long-held assumption about dinosaur biology

PROCESS

1. Spot the shift: “For decades...” then “however”.
2. Job: new evidence against an old assumption.
3. Test each choice: criticise? definitive claim? reptiles?
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ No criticism of methods is made.
- B** ✓ **It presents new evidence against an old assumption.**
- C** ✗ The passage stops short of a definitive claim.
- D** ✗ Reptiles are mentioned only briefly.

TIP

- “For decades... however” = old view, then new evidence.
- Look at the last sentence: it only “proposes” a middle ground.

TRAP

- “Definitively” is too extreme: the text proposes only a “middle ground”.
- A passing detail (modern reptiles) offered as the whole purpose.

Worked Example 2.3



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Public libraries have increasingly become spaces for services beyond lending books, offering job-search assistance, free tax preparation, and even social work referrals. Supporters argue this expansion meets real community needs that other institutions have failed to address. Critics, however, worry that libraries risk losing their core identity as centers of literacy and quiet study.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To argue that libraries should abandon their traditional role entirely
- B** To present both sides of a debate about the expanding role of public libraries
- C** To provide a history of how public libraries were originally funded
- D** To criticize critics of library expansion as out of touch

2

Worked Example 2.3: Solution

Answer: B — To present both sides of a debate about the expanding role of public libraries

PROCESS

1. Notice the structure: services → supporters → critics.
2. Job: present two views of one issue.
3. Cross out choices that take a side or add history.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The passage never says libraries should abandon their role.
- B** ✓ **It gives supporters' and critics' views.**
- C** ✗ Funding history is not discussed.
- D** ✗ Critics are presented neutrally.

TIP

- “Supporters... Critics...” = both sides.
- Neutral wording means a neutral purpose.

TRAP

- Strong verbs (abandon, criticize) when the passage stays neutral.
- A history of funding that is never discussed.

Worked Example 2.4



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

When a driverless car must choose between two harmful outcomes — for instance, swerving to avoid a pedestrian but risking the passenger’s safety — the decision is encoded in advance by engineers, not made in the moment by a human. This raises difficult questions about who bears moral responsibility when the car’s programmed choice results in harm.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To describe a specific traffic accident involving a driverless car
- B** To explain how driverless cars are manufactured
- C** To raise an ethical question posed by decisions programmed into driverless cars
- D** To argue that driverless cars should be banned from public roads

2

Worked Example 2.4: Solution

Answer: C — To raise an ethical question posed by decisions programmed into driverless cars

PROCESS

1. Find the key phrase: “raises difficult questions”.
2. Job: raise a moral question.
3. Cross out choices that describe an accident, manufacturing or a ban.
4. C matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ No real accident is described.
- B** ✗ Manufacturing is not discussed.
- C** ✓ **The passage raises an ethical question.**
- D** ✗ No argument for a ban is made.

TIP

- “This raises difficult questions” names the job outright.
- The example (“for instance”) supports the point; it is not the point.

TRAP

- Treating a hypothetical as if it were a real accident.
- Choosing “ban”: the passage asks a question, it does not demand an action.

Worked Example 2.5



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

In 1928, Alexander Fleming returned from vacation to find that a stray mold had contaminated one of his bacterial cultures — and that bacteria near the mold had died. Rather than discarding the ruined experiment, Fleming investigated further, eventually identifying the mold's antibacterial compound as penicillin.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A

To argue that scientific breakthroughs are mostly a matter of luck

B

To describe how Fleming's careful attention to an unexpected result led to the discovery of penicillin

C

To explain the chemical structure of penicillin

D

To compare Fleming's discovery to later advances in antibiotics

Worked Example 2.5: Solution

Answer: B — To describe how Fleming's careful attention to an unexpected result led to the discovery of penicillin

PROCESS

1. Notice the order: accident → follow-up → discovery.
2. Job: describe how one event led to a discovery.
3. Cross out sweeping claims and missing topics.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The passage tells one story; it does not make a general claim.
- B** ✓ **It describes the accident and the deliberate follow-up.**
- C** ✗ Chemical structure is not discussed.
- D** ✗ No later advances are mentioned.

TIP

- One event told in order = describe, not a claim about science in general.
- “Rather than discarding” shows deliberate follow-up.

TRAP

- “Mostly luck” is broader than one story and ignores Fleming's follow-up.
- Choosing a chemistry topic that never appears.

Worked Example 2.6



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Urban planners have begun experimenting with ‘shared streets,’ removing curbs and traffic signs so that pedestrians, cyclists, and cars must negotiate space visually rather than by strict right-of-way rules. Early data from several European cities suggests that, counterintuitively, accident rates in these zones have dropped, possibly because drivers slow down and pay closer attention without the false confidence of clear signals.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To argue that traffic signs should be eliminated everywhere
- B** To describe an unconventional street design and a surprising early result associated with it
- C** To compare European and American approaches to urban planning
- D** To criticize drivers for relying too heavily on traffic signals

2

Worked Example 2.6: Solution

Answer: B — To describe an unconventional street design and a surprising early result associated with it

PROCESS

1. Spot the structure: a new design, then a surprising result.
2. Job: describe the design and its result.
3. Cross out “everywhere”, “American” and “criticize”.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The passage describes specific zones, not all places.
- B** ✓ **It describes the design and a surprising early result.**
- C** ✗ No American comparison is made.
- D** ✗ Drivers are not criticized; a possible reason is given.

TIP

- “Counterintuitively” signals a surprising result.
- “Early data... suggests” means a cautious tone.

TRAP

- “Everywhere” turns an experiment into a universal demand.
- Reading a possible explanation as criticism.

Worked Example 2.7



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Octopuses possess a distributed nervous system, with roughly two-thirds of their neurons located in their arms rather than their central brain. This has led some researchers to question whether each arm operates with a degree of independent ‘decision-making,’ complicating traditional definitions of intelligence that assume a single centralized controller.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To prove that octopuses are more intelligent than humans
- B** To describe octopus anatomy in full detail
- C** To explain how octopus neurology challenges conventional ideas about intelligence
- D** To argue that all animals should be studied using the same definition of intelligence

2

Worked Example 2.7: Solution

Answer: C — To explain how octopus neurology challenges conventional ideas about intelligence

PROCESS

1. Spot the structure: an anatomical fact, then its consequence.
2. Job: explain how a fact challenges an idea.
3. Cross out “prove”, “full detail” and the reversed claim.
4. C matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ No comparison with humans is made.
- B** ✗ Only the nervous system is discussed.
- C** ✓ **A specific fact challenges the idea of centralized intelligence.**
- D** ✗ The passage suggests definitions need rethinking, not uniform use.

TIP

- A fact followed by “has led researchers to question” = a challenge to an idea.
- Read the verb carefully in every choice.

TRAP

- Choice D is the OPPOSITE of the passage’s point.
- “Prove” is too strong for “some researchers question”.

Worked Example 2.8



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Interest rates set by central banks affect nearly every corner of an economy, from mortgage payments to business loans. When a bank raises rates to control inflation, borrowing becomes more expensive, which can slow consumer spending — but if rates rise too quickly, the resulting slowdown can tip an economy into recession.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

- A** To explain how interest rate changes ripple through an economy, including the risk of moving too far
- B** To argue that central banks should never raise interest rates
- C** To describe the history of a specific central bank's policies
- D** To compare interest rates across different countries

2

Worked Example 2.8: Solution

Answer: A — To explain how interest rate changes ripple through an economy, including the risk of moving too far

PROCESS

1. Spot the structure: a mechanism, then a risk (“but if...”).
2. Job: explain the chain and its danger.
3. Cross out choices that argue, give history or compare.
4. A matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ It explains the mechanism and its risk.
- B** ✗ The passage says too-fast rises are risky, not that rises are wrong.
- C** ✗ No specific bank or history is named.
- D** ✗ No country comparison is made.

TIP

- “But if rates rise too quickly” — pick the choice that includes the risk.
- Explaining a chain of effects is a common job.

TRAP

- “Never raise rates” turns a warning into an absolute rule.
- Choosing a detail when the question asks for the whole job.

Worked Example 2.9



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Composting turns kitchen scraps and yard waste into nutrient-rich soil, reducing the volume of trash sent to landfills. Landfilled organic waste, however, decomposes without oxygen and releases methane, a greenhouse gas far more potent than carbon dioxide. Composting therefore addresses both a waste problem and a climate problem at once.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

A

To introduce a counterargument against composting

B

To explain why organic waste in landfills poses a specific environmental problem, motivating the case for composting

C

To provide a historical account of landfill practices

D

To concede a weakness in the argument for composting

Worked Example 2.9: Solution



Answer: B — To explain why organic waste in landfills poses a specific environmental problem, motivating the case for composting

PROCESS

1. Reread the sentence with the ones before and after it.
2. Disappearance test: without it, why composting helps the climate disappears.
3. Predict the verb: explain, setting up the conclusion.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The sentence supports composting; it does not argue against it.
- B** ✓ **It explains the landfill problem that composting solves.**
- C** ✗ No history is given.
- D** ✗ No weakness of composting is conceded.

TIP

- Look at the LAST sentence: “therefore” links back to this sentence.
- Ask what the next sentence depends on.

TRAP

- “However” makes it look like a counterargument, but it supports composting.
- Choosing “concede”: nothing is admitted against composting.

Worked Example 2.10



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Many assume that multitasking allows people to get more done in less time. Cognitive research, however, consistently shows that switching between tasks incurs a measurable time cost, as the brain must reorient itself each time. Some researchers now argue that what feels like multitasking is really just rapid task-switching, with efficiency lost at every switch.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

- A To provide an example of successful multitasking
- B To introduce evidence that challenges the common assumption stated in the first sentence
- C To summarize the passage's overall argument
- D To concede that multitasking has some benefits

Worked Example 2.10: Solution

Answer: B — To introduce evidence that challenges the common assumption stated in the first sentence

PROCESS

1. Reread: assumption → highlighted sentence → further argument.
2. Disappearance test: the evidence against the assumption would disappear.
3. Predict the verb: challenge, with evidence.
4. B matches.

TIP

- “Many assume... however” = the “however” sentence challenges the assumption.
- A middle sentence is rarely the summary.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ It describes a cost, not a success.
- B** ✓ **It introduces research that challenges the opening assumption.**
- C** ✗ A third sentence still follows.
- D** ✗ No benefit is conceded.

TRAP

- Choosing “summarize” because it sounds like a strong sentence.
- Reading “time cost” as a benefit.

Worked Example 2.11



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The city's new curbside composting program has been praised for diverting waste from landfills. Enrollment, however, remains voluntary, and only about 15 percent of eligible households have signed up so far. Officials say they are considering incentives to boost participation in the coming year.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

- A** To introduce a limitation on the program's current success
- B** To provide an example of a household that benefited from the program
- C** To conclude the passage with a final recommendation
- D** To explain the scientific mechanism behind composting

Worked Example 2.11: Solution

Answer: A — To introduce a limitation on the program's current success

PROCESS

1. Reread: praise → highlighted sentence → future plans.
2. Disappearance test: the limit on the program's success would vanish.
3. Predict the verb: qualify.
4. A matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ It limits the praised success of the program.
- B** ✗ No specific household is described.
- C** ✗ A third sentence follows, so this is not the end.
- D** ✗ Composting science is not discussed.

TIP

- Praise, then “however” = a limitation.
- Check the next sentence: it is about future incentives.

TRAP

- “Conclude” — the passage continues after this sentence.
- A statistic is not an example of one household.

Worked Example 2.12



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Some economists argue that a shorter workweek would boost productivity by reducing burnout.

Admittedly, a handful of small pilot studies have shown promising short-term results. Critics point out, however, that these studies rarely account for industries where round-the-clock coverage is essential, such as healthcare.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

A To refute the claim made in the first sentence

B To concede a point in favor of the shorter-workweek argument before the passage raises a limitation

C To provide the passage's final conclusion

D To introduce an entirely new, unrelated topic

2

Worked Example 2.12: Solution

Answer: B — To concede a point in favor of the shorter-workweek argument before the passage raises a limitation

PROCESS

1. Reread: claim → highlighted sentence → critics' point.
2. Spot the signal: "Admittedly".
3. Predict the verb: concede — grant a point.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ It supports the claim rather than refuting it.
- B** ✓ **"Admittedly" concedes a point before the critique.**
- C** ✗ The passage continues after it.
- D** ✗ The topic does not change.

TIP

- "Admittedly" = a concession.
- A concession comes before the writer's real point.

TRAP

- Calling the sentence a refutation: it supports the claim.
- "Conclusion": the passage continues with the critics.

Worked Example 2.13



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The ancient library of Alexandria is often remembered as a symbol of lost knowledge.

Historical accounts of its destruction, however, differ significantly, with some blaming a single catastrophic fire and others describing a slower decline over centuries due to neglect and funding cuts. Modern historians tend to favor the gradual-decline explanation.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

- A To provide the passage's single, agreed-upon explanation for the library's destruction
- B To introduce competing explanations for the library's destruction, setting up the historians' preferred view in the next sentence
- C To argue that the library's destruction is unknowable
- D To describe the library's original collection of scrolls

Worked Example 2.13: Solution

Answer: B — To introduce competing explanations for the library's destruction, setting up the historians' preferred view in the next sentence

PROCESS

1. Reread: symbol → highlighted sentence → historians' preference.
2. Spot the key words: "differ significantly".
3. Predict the verb: introduce competing views.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The sentence shows disagreement.
- B** ✓ **It sets out competing explanations before the favored one.**
- C** ✗ The passage never calls the cause unknowable.
- D** ✗ The collection is never described.

TIP

- "Differ" = competing explanations.
- Read the next sentence: it chooses between them.

TRAP

- "Unknowable" is more extreme than the text: historians favor one view.
- "Single, agreed-upon" is the reverse of "differ".

Worked Example 2.14



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Vertical farming — growing crops in stacked indoor layers rather than open fields — promises higher yields per square foot and protection from unpredictable weather. The energy required to power artificial lighting, however, remains substantial, and some analyses suggest the carbon footprint of that electricity can offset the method's environmental benefits.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted second sentence in the text as a whole?

- A** To qualify the benefits described in the first sentence with a significant drawback
- B** To provide a detailed history of vertical farming's invention
- C** To argue that vertical farming should be banned
- D** To describe a specific vertical farm's crop yield

Worked Example 2.14: Solution

Answer: A — To qualify the benefits described in the first sentence with a significant drawback

PROCESS

1. Reread: benefits → highlighted sentence.
2. Spot the signal: “however”.
3. Predict the verb: qualify with a drawback.
4. A matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ It adds a drawback to the benefits.
- B** ✗ No history is given.
- C** ✗ The passage raises a concern, not a ban.
- D** ✗ No specific farm is described.

TIP

- Benefits first, then “however” + drawback = qualify.
- Ask: does the sentence reject the idea or just limit it?

TRAP

- “Banned” is a leap from raising a concern to demanding an action.
- Choosing a history or a number the passage never gives.

Worked Example 2.15



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

Wearable fitness trackers have become common tools for monitoring daily activity. Several independent studies, however, have found meaningful discrepancies between tracker-reported calorie burn and results measured in controlled lab settings, with some devices overestimating burn by more than 25 percent. Manufacturers maintain that the devices are intended for tracking relative trends, not precise measurement.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted third sentence in the text as a whole?

- A** To present the manufacturers' response to the accuracy concerns raised in the previous sentence
- B** To provide new evidence that trackers are, in fact, highly accurate
- C** To introduce the passage's main topic
- D** To describe how fitness trackers are manufactured

Worked Example 2.15: Solution

Answer: A — To present the manufacturers' response to the accuracy concerns raised in the previous sentence

PROCESS

1. Reread: common tools → criticism → highlighted sentence.
2. Spot the key word: “maintain” (reporting someone’s view).
3. Predict the verb: respond to the criticism.
4. A matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ It presents the manufacturers’ response.
- B** ✗ It is a defense, not new evidence of accuracy.
- C** ✗ The topic was introduced earlier.
- D** ✗ Manufacturing is not discussed.

TIP

- “Manufacturers maintain” = a response from one side.
- Ask who is speaking: the manufacturers, answering critics.

TRAP

- Confusing a defense with proof.
- “Main topic”: the topic was introduced in sentence one.

Worked Example 2.16



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

The Icelandic language has changed relatively little since the 9th century, and modern speakers can still read medieval sagas with only modest difficulty. Iceland's historical isolation from mainland Europe is often credited for this remarkable linguistic stability.

Not all isolated language communities remain so stable, however, suggesting isolation alone cannot fully explain the phenomenon.

Which choice best describes the function of the highlighted third sentence in the text as a whole?

- A** To restate the passage's opening claim about Icelandic's stability
- B** To complicate the explanation offered in the previous sentence by noting its limits
- C** To provide an extended example of another stable language
- D** To conclude that isolation has no effect on language stability whatsoever

Worked Example 2.16: Solution

Answer: B — To complicate the explanation offered in the previous sentence by noting its limits

PROCESS

1. Reread: claim → explanation (isolation) → highlighted sentence.
2. Spot the words: “not all... however... alone cannot fully explain”.
3. Predict the verb: complicate the explanation.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ It does not repeat the opening claim.
- B** ✓ **It limits the isolation explanation.**
- C** ✗ No other specific language is described.
- D** ✗ The text says isolation “alone” is not enough, not that it has no effect.

TIP

- “Alone cannot fully explain” = limits an explanation without rejecting it.
- Compare the strength of the choice with the strength of the sentence.

TRAP

- “No effect whatsoever” is far stronger than “alone cannot fully explain”.
- Choosing “restate”: the sentence adds something new.

3

Cross-Text Connections

Name the relationship between two texts.

Σύνδεση Μεταξύ Κειμένων

THEORY
7 slides

WORKED EXAMPLES
8 questions

The big idea



WHAT IT IS

Cross-Text Connections questions test whether you can see how two authors' claims relate: agreement, disagreement, extension, qualification, application, or problem and response. A one-sentence summary of each text usually IS your answer.

EXAMPLE

Text 1: screen time causes anxiety. Text 2: anxiety came first. → Disagreement.

KEY TERM • ΕΛΛΗΝΙΚΑ

Σύνδεση Μεταξύ Κειμένων

Η κατανόηση της σχέσης ανάμεσα στις απόψεις δύο συγγραφέων (συμφωνία, διαφωνία, επέκταση).

WHY IT MATTERS

- About one question per test
- 49% use “how would the author of Text 2 respond...” wording
- 71% rated Hard, 13% Easy — a method makes it approachable

Six relationship types

TYPE	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW TEXT 2 SOUNDS
Agreement	<i>Both texts reach the same conclusion.</i>	“Similarly... this confirms...”
Disagreement	<i>Text 2 refutes Text 1’s central claim.</i>	“However, the evidence shows the reverse...”
Extension	<i>Text 2 adds depth or breadth to the idea.</i>	“Moreover, this also applies to...”
Qualification	<i>Text 2 accepts the claim but limits it.</i>	“...holds only when...”
Application	<i>Text 2 applies the idea to a new case.</i>	“In one city, exactly this happened...”
Problem → response	<i>Text 2 answers a concern Text 1 raises.</i>	“One review found that...”

3

The 5-step method

1

Read both

Read each text fully before comparing them.

2

Summarize

Write one sentence per text, in your own words.

3

Name it

Choose the relationship type before reading the choices.

4

Check direction

Text 2 responding to Text 1 is not the same as the reverse.

5

Reject overstatement

One limit = qualify, not refute. Check who said what.



Who is speaking about whom?

QUESTION WORDING	WHOSE VIEW?	WHAT TO ASK
“How would the author of Text 2 respond to Text 1?”	<i>Text 2’s author</i>	What does Text 2 say about Text 1’s claim?
“How would the author of Text 1 describe the findings in Text 2?”	<i>Text 1’s author</i>	Would Text 1’s author accept, limit or reject those findings?
“How does Text 2 relate to Text 1?”	<i>Neutral</i>	Which relationship type is it?

Words that overstate — and words that fit

Overstating (usually wrong)

- entirely • completely • always • never
- proves • disproves • fabricated
- “no effect on any outcome”

Measured (often right)

- suggests • complicates • narrows
- partially supports • adds nuance
- challenges one part of the claim

The rule

- Match the strength of the texts
- One limit = qualifying
- Wrong answers often swap the authors

3

Spot the overstated answer — and fix it

WRONG

✗ Text 2 proves Text 1 is entirely wrong.

✗ Text 2 shows the policy has no effect at all.

✗ Text 1's author would call Text 2 irrelevant.

✗ Text 2's author makes Text 1's argument.

RIGHT

→
✓ Text 2 challenges one part of Text 1's claim.

→
✓ Text 2 shows the policy has a smaller effect than Text 1 claims.

→
✓ Text 1's author would call Text 2 a partial test of the claim.

→
✓ Text 1's author makes the argument; Text 2's author responds.

WHY

One counter-finding is not a total refutation.

"No effect at all" overstates modest results.

Both texts discuss the same question.

Check who said what.

Cross-text connections in three lines



First

- Read each text fully
- Write a one-sentence summary of each

Then

- Name the relationship type
- Check the question's direction

Watch out

- Reject overstated choices
- Wrong answers swap the authors
- Do not compare halfway through Text 1



3

Worked Example 3.1

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Some sociologists argue that social media use among teenagers is a primary driver of rising anxiety rates, citing correlational studies linking screen time to self-reported mood declines.

TEXT 2

A longitudinal study tracking the same 2,000 teenagers over five years found that anxiety symptoms often preceded increased social media use, not the other way around, suggesting existing anxiety may drive teens toward more screen time rather than the reverse.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 2 most likely respond to the argument in Text 1?

- A By fully agreeing that social media causes teenage anxiety
- B By questioning the direction of the causal relationship Text 1 assumes
- C By arguing that anxiety rates are not actually rising among teenagers
- D By proposing an entirely unrelated cause of teenage anxiety

3

Worked Example 3.1: Solution

Answer: B — By questioning the direction of the causal relationship Text 1 assumes

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: social media drives teen anxiety (correlational evidence).
2. Summarize Text 2: a longitudinal study found anxiety often came first.
3. Name the relationship: disagreement about the direction of cause.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ Text 2 challenges, rather than agrees with, the causal claim.
- B** ✓ **Text 2 questions which way the cause runs.**
- C** ✗ Text 2 does not dispute that anxiety is rising.
- D** ✗ Text 2 stays on the same topic.

TIP

- Write one line per text before reading the choices.
- “Longitudinal” beats “correlational” — it is the key contrast.

TRAP

- “Fully agreeing” is the reverse of Text 2’s finding.
- Choice C: Text 2 never says anxiety is not rising.



3

Worked Example 3.2

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Advocates of universal basic income argue that providing unconditional cash payments reduces poverty and gives recipients more freedom to pursue education or entrepreneurship.

TEXT 2

A pilot program in Finland found that basic income recipients reported higher well-being and modestly increased job-seeking activity compared to a control group, though overall employment rates were similar between groups.

How would the author of Text 1 most likely describe the findings in Text 2?

A

As direct proof that the theory in Text 1 is entirely wrong

B

As evidence that partially supports the well-being claims made in Text 1, while adding nuance about employment effects

C

As completely irrelevant to the debate over universal basic income

D

As proof that basic income has no effect on any measured outcome

3

Worked Example 3.2: Solution

Answer: B — As evidence that partially supports the well-being claims made in Text 1, while adding nuance about employment effects

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: basic income reduces poverty and gives freedom.
2. Summarize Text 2: higher well-being, more job-seeking, no employment change.
3. Name the relationship: partial support with a limit (qualification).
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ Higher well-being supports part of Text 1.
- B** ✓ **It partly supports Text 1 and adds nuance.**
- C** ✗ Text 2 tests the very claims in Text 1.
- D** ✗ Some effects were found.

TIP

- Mixed results usually point to “partially supports”.
- Check each choice for words like “entirely” or “no effect”.

TRAP

- “Entirely wrong” and “no effect on any outcome” overstate mixed results.
- Calling a direct test of the claims “irrelevant”.



3

Worked Example 3.3

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Some marine biologists have proposed that octopuses' short lifespans, typically one to two years, may be an evolutionary trade-off: a compressed life cycle that allows for rapid reproduction in an environment full of predators.

TEXT 2

Researchers studying a related cephalopod species with an unusually long lifespan of over four years found no corresponding decrease in reproductive output compared to shorter-lived relatives, complicating simple trade-off explanations.

How would the author of Text 1 most likely respond to the findings in Text 2?

A

By conceding that the proposed trade-off may not apply as universally as first suggested

B

By arguing that Text 2's findings are fabricated

C

By claiming Text 2 confirms the trade-off theory in Text 1

D

By insisting that all cephalopod species must have short lifespans

3

Worked Example 3.3: Solution

Answer: A — By conceding that the proposed trade-off may not apply as universally as first suggested

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: short life = a trade-off for fast reproduction.
2. Summarize Text 2: a long-lived relative still reproduced well.
3. Name the relationship: the theory needs narrowing (qualification).
4. A matches.

TIP

- “Complicating” in Text 2 is the hint: expect a limit, not a rejection.
- Words like “conceding” and “may not apply” are measured.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ The theory may not hold as universally as proposed.
- B** ✗ Nothing suggests the findings are fabricated.
- C** ✗ Text 2 complicates, not confirms.
- D** ✗ Text 2 describes a long-lived cephalopod.

TRAP

- Choice D contradicts Text 2, which describes a long-lived species.
- “Fabricated” is not supported by anything in either text.

Worked Example 3.4



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Urban planners have found that adding more traffic lanes to relieve congestion often backfires, a phenomenon known as induced demand, where added capacity simply attracts more drivers until congestion returns to previous levels.

TEXT 2

A ten-year study of a highway expansion project in Texas found that traffic volume increased by nearly the same percentage as the added lane capacity, and average commute times returned to pre-expansion levels within five years.

How would the author of Text 1 most likely describe the study in Text 2?

A

As a counterexample that disproves the concept of induced demand

B

As a real-world case study that supports the concept of induced demand described in Text 1

C

As entirely unrelated to traffic planning

D

As proof that highway expansion always reduces congestion permanently

Worked Example 3.4: Solution

Answer: B — As a real-world case study that supports the concept of induced demand described in Text 1

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: extra lanes attract more drivers (induced demand).
2. Summarize Text 2: a Texas expansion saw traffic rise and commutes return to old levels.
3. Name the relationship: a real case that applies the idea (application).
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ The results match induced demand; they do not disprove it.
- B** ✓ **A real case supports the concept.**
- C** ✗ The study is about traffic and lanes.
- D** ✗ Congestion returned, so nothing permanent was reduced.

TIP

- Ask: does Text 2 match the pattern Text 1 predicts? Yes → it supports.
- “Case study” is a signal for application.

TRAP

- Reading “congestion returned” as a counterexample.
- “Always... permanently” is an absolute that the study contradicts.



3

Worked Example 3.5

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Some economists argue that raising the minimum wage leads employers to reduce staff hours or automate more tasks, ultimately harming the low-wage workers the policy intends to help.

TEXT 2

A comparative analysis of neighboring counties with different minimum wage laws found no significant difference in overall employment levels between the two, though the higher-wage county did see modestly increased prices at fast-food restaurants.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 1 most likely respond to the findings in Text 2?

A

By arguing that Text 2 fully confirms the harm predicted in Text 1

B

By pointing out that Text 2's findings challenge the specific employment-harm prediction made in Text 1

C

By claiming Text 2 has nothing to do with minimum wage policy

D

By insisting that prices must fall when the minimum wage rises

3

Worked Example 3.5: Solution

Answer: B — By pointing out that Text 2’s findings challenge the specific employment-harm prediction made in Text 1

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: higher minimum wage cuts jobs and hurts workers.
2. Summarize Text 2: no employment difference, slightly higher prices.
3. Name the relationship: Text 2 challenges Text 1’s job-loss prediction.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ No employment difference does not confirm job loss.
- B** ✓ **The findings challenge the employment-harm prediction.**
- C** ✗ Text 2 tests the very policy in Text 1.
- D** ✗ Text 2 found prices rose.

TIP

- Compare the key prediction with the key finding: job loss vs. no difference.
- Do not let the price detail distract you.

TRAP

- “Fully confirms” reverses the finding.
- Choice D adds a claim about falling prices that neither text makes.



3

Worked Example 3.6

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Some nutrition researchers have proposed that intermittent fasting improves metabolic health primarily by extending the daily period without food intake, regardless of total calorie consumption.

TEXT 2

A controlled trial comparing two groups eating the same total daily calories — one within a restricted eight-hour window and one spread across sixteen hours — found no significant difference in metabolic markers between groups after twelve weeks.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 1 most likely respond to the findings in Text 2?

A

By conceding that the timing window alone, independent of calorie intake, may not be the deciding factor after all

B

By arguing that Text 2 fully supports the fasting-window theory in Text 1

C

By dismissing Text 2 as irrelevant to metabolic research

D

By claiming Text 2 proves fasting has no health benefits of any kind

3

Worked Example 3.6: Solution

Answer: A — By conceding that the timing window alone, independent of calorie intake, may not be the deciding factor after all

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: the fasting window itself improves health.
2. Summarize Text 2: same calories, different windows, no difference.
3. Name the relationship: the mechanism is challenged (qualification).
4. A matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✓ **The window alone may not matter.**
- B** ✗ Text 2 found no support for the window theory.
- C** ✗ Text 2 isolates the same variable as Text 1.
- D** ✗ One narrow result does not prove no benefit at all.

TIP

- “Controlled trial” isolates one variable — treat it as strong evidence.
- Choose measured wording such as “may not be the deciding factor”.

TRAP

- “Fully supports” is the opposite of “no significant difference”.
- “No health benefits of any kind” is a sweeping leap from one narrow finding.



3

Worked Example 3.7

CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Historians have traditionally credited the printing press with dramatically increasing literacy rates across Europe within a generation of its invention.

TEXT 2

An analysis of church and guild records from several German towns found that literacy rates rose only gradually over nearly a century following the printing press's introduction, with the steepest gains concentrated in urban merchant classes rather than the general population.

How would the author of Text 1 most likely describe the analysis in Text 2?

A

As full confirmation of the traditional, rapid-increase account

B

As an extension that adds detail and a needed correction to the pace and distribution of the traditional account

C

As proof that the printing press had no effect on literacy at all

D

As unrelated to the history of the printing press

3

Worked Example 3.7: Solution

Answer: B — As an extension that adds detail and a needed correction to the pace and distribution of the traditional account

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: the press quickly raised literacy.
2. Summarize Text 2: literacy rose slowly and unevenly.
3. Name the relationship: it refines the traditional account.
4. B matches.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ Text 2 shows a slower, uneven rise.
- B** ✓ **Text 2 adds detail and corrects the pace and spread.**
- C** ✗ Literacy still increased.
- D** ✗ Text 2 studies the press's impact.

TIP

- Contrast the two key words: “within a generation” vs. “nearly a century”.
- Literacy still rose in Text 2, so “no effect” is wrong.

TRAP

- “Full confirmation” ignores “only gradually”.
- “No effect at all” overstates: literacy did rise.

Worked Example 3.8



CLC PRACTICE QUESTION

TEXT 1

Public health officials have raised concerns that widespread use of antibacterial hand soap in households may contribute to bacterial resistance, similar to concerns raised about antibiotic overuse.

TEXT 2

A review of laboratory studies found that the active antibacterial ingredient in most household soaps, triclosan, does not appear to promote resistance to medically important antibiotics at the concentrations typically used in consumer products.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 1 most likely respond to the review described in Text 2?

- A By fully abandoning any concern about antibacterial products given Text 2's findings
- B By narrowing the specific concern in light of Text 2's finding, while noting the review addresses one ingredient at typical household concentrations
- C By arguing that Text 2's findings are completely consistent with Text 1's original concern as stated
- D By claiming Text 2 is not about antibacterial products at all

3

Worked Example 3.8: Solution

Answer: B — By narrowing the specific concern in light of Text 2’s finding, while noting the review addresses one ingredient at typical household concentrations

PROCESS

1. Summarize Text 1: antibacterial soap may cause resistance.
2. Summarize Text 2: one ingredient did not cause resistance at typical levels.
3. Name the relationship: the concern is narrowed (qualification).
4. B matches.

TIP

- Look for limits in Text 2: “one ingredient”, “typical concentrations”.
- A narrow finding calls for a narrowed response, not a total reversal.

PROCESS OF ELIMINATION

- A** ✗ One review of one ingredient does not remove all concern.
- B** ✓ **The concern is narrowed, with the limits noted.**
- C** ✗ Text 2’s finding complicates the broad concern.
- D** ✗ Text 2 studies antibacterial soap ingredients.

TRAP

- “Fully abandoning” overstates what one review shows.
- “Completely consistent” ignores that Text 2 found no resistance.



Signal word master table

SIGNAL WORDS	WHAT THEY SIGNAL	WHERE YOU WILL USE THEM
However • but • yet • although • despite • whereas	Contrast: opposite meaning or counterpoint	All three skills
Because • therefore • as a result • consequently • so	Cause and effect	Words in Context, Structure
For example • for instance • such as • including	An example follows	Words in Context, Structure
That is • in other words • also known as	A definition follows	Words in Context
Moreover • furthermore • in addition	Addition: same direction as before	Structure, Cross-Text
Thus • therefore • in summary • overall	Conclusion	Structure
Acknowledge • admit • grant • concede	Concession: the real point is in the “however” sentence	Structure, Cross-Text
A dash (—) or a colon (:)	A definition or explanation follows	Words in Context, Structure



Top rules for each skill

Words in Context

- Predict before you look at the choices
- However / but / yet → opposite
- Colons and dashes introduce definitions
- Tone removes at least one wrong choice
- The most common meaning is almost always wrong

Text Structure and Purpose

- Ask “What is this DOING?”
- Memorize: introduce, support, challenge, concede, conclude
- However → challenge; for example → illustrate
- Disappearance test for highlighted sentences
- Cut ideas that are not in the passage

Cross-Text Connections

- Read each text fully first
- One-sentence summary of each
- Name the relationship type before the choices
- Check the direction of the question
- Reject overstatement; watch who said what



REMEMBER



Where to spend your practice time

100%

of real Words in Context questions are rated Hard

Predict first, every time

96%

of real Text Structure and Purpose questions are rated Hard

Ask what the text is DOING

71%

of real Cross-Text Connections questions are rated Hard

Summarize both, then name the link